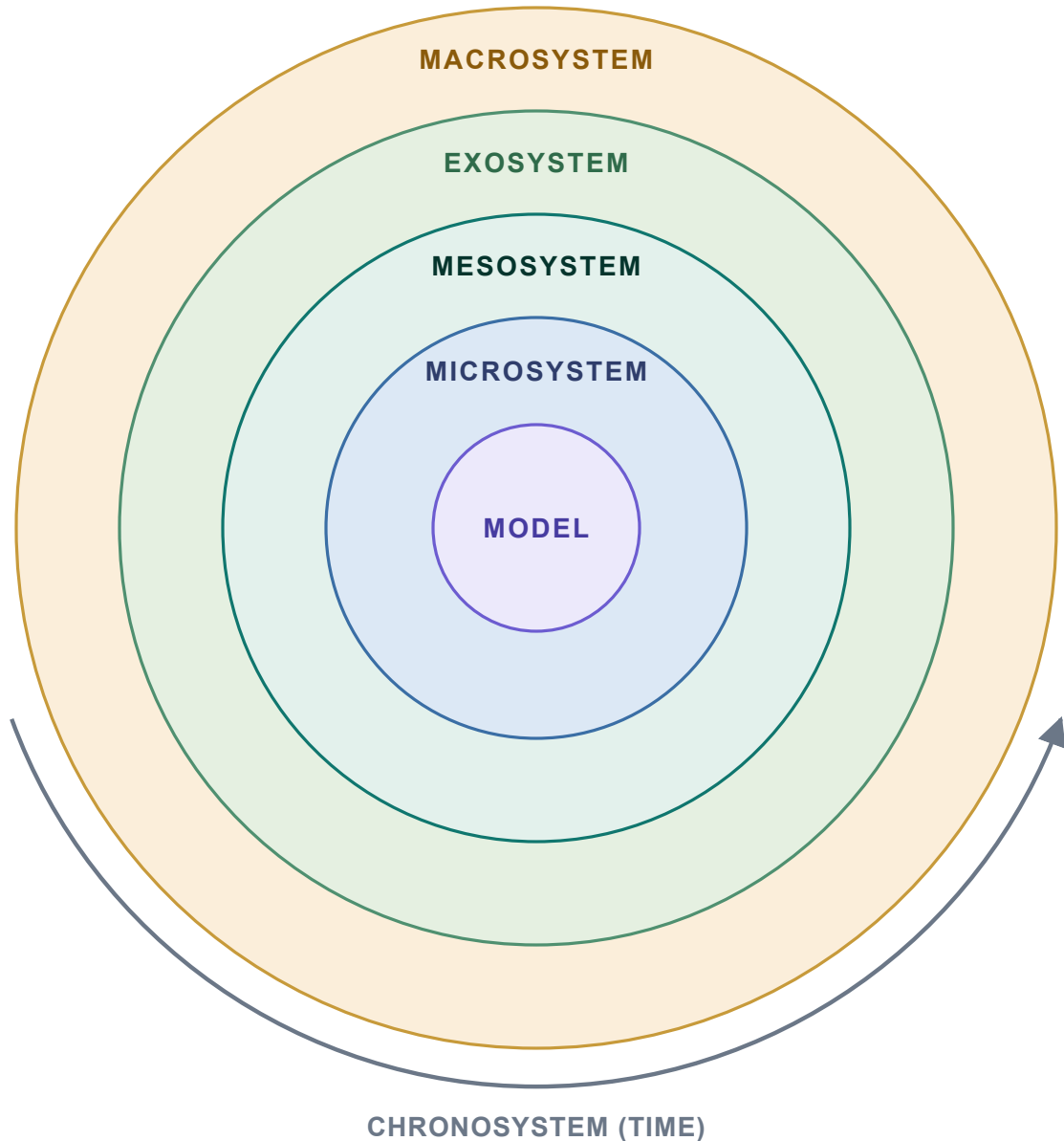




What each ring holds for an AI agent

individual model



Model

weights, training,
system prompt

agent-group interactions



Microsystem

its user, tools, memory, task,
and the agents it talks to



Mesosystem

handoffs, orchestrators, memory
shared across tasks

governing institutions



Exosystem

platform policy, API limits, other firms'
agents, the monitoring stack



Macrosystem

law and regulation, market structure,
professional norms, cultural values



Chronosystem

model updates, drift, deprecations,
incidents that change the rules

After Bronfenbrenner (1979). Brackets show the three levels of Fig. 2A.